PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Jeep Wrangler JL Unlimited

2018–present · JL Unlimited · 4xe · 392

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Run the VIN for every recall**
  Look for the frame and track-bar welds and the steering damper on 2018–19 trucks, the clutch on manuals, the 2018 park-lock rod (18V-280) and cruise-control software (18V-332) campaigns, the power-steering pump (26V-363, 2021–2025), the 4xe battery (24V-720 / 25V-741) and the EcoDiesel fuel pump (22V-767 and 23V-263). Get dealer printouts showing they're complete.
- [ ] **4xe: test the charging**
  Plug it in. Pickup Truck + SUV Talk says owners often complain the 4xe won't charge from an outlet, blaming software, connections or an overheating control module.
- [ ] **EcoDiesel: fuel and emissions history**
  Ask for fuel-filter receipts and the recall record. A high-pressure pump failure is expensive, and debris contamination is what the recall addressed.
- [ ] **392: it's a different 4WD system**
  The 392 uses full-time Selec-Trac and the ZF 8HP75, not Rock-Trac. Check the differential and transfer-case fluids. KBB put a new 2025 Rubicon 392 at $101,990, so price used ones against the trim and condition.
- [ ] **Steering feel**
  Wandering or vague steering on 2018–2020 trucks points to the early aluminum steering box (owners cite TSB 08-074-20). Shake after bumps points to the damper, track bar or worn joints.
- [ ] **Pentastar oil cooler**
  Look for oil in the engine valley and down the back of the block.
- [ ] **Payload versus build**
  Read the door sticker, then add up the bumpers, winch, rack, drawers and passengers. Quadratec lists 880–1,351 lb for 2020–21 four-doors depending on trim.
- [ ] **Do you want the 2024 updates?**
  Side-curtain airbags, the bigger screen, a 5,000-lb tow option and the factory winch all arrived for 2024, the same year the EcoDiesel disappeared.

YEARS TO KNOW

2018	BEWARE	JL launch (four-door production from November 2017, two-door from early 2018): 3.6 Pentastar with a 6-speed manual or 8-speed auto, plus a 2.0 turbo with eTorque (auto only). The year to be wary of: NHTSA recalls cover track-bar bracket welds (18V-675), the intermediate steering shaft weld (18V-343) and rear frame-rail corrosion (18V-231), manual trucks are in the clutch recalls, and SlashGear counts more than 1,000 owner complaints, mostly highway wander. Buy one only with every fix documented

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Front track bar bracket welds (the 'frame weld' recall)**
  2018–2019 · NHTSA 18V-675
- [ ] **Intermediate steering shaft weld**
  2018 · NHTSA 18V-343
- [ ] **Rear underbody ladder rail corrosion**
  2018 · NHTSA 18V-231
- [ ] **Steering column stub shaft**
  2019 · NHTSA 19V-201
- [ ] **Manual-transmission clutch pressure plate**
  2018–2020 · NHTSA 20V-124
- [ ] **Clutch overheating software**
  2018–2021 · NHTSA 21V-028
- [ ] **Clutch assembly replacement**
  2018–2023 · NHTSA 23V-116
- [ ] **Left lower control arm bracket weld**
  2020 · NHTSA 20V-042
- [ ] **Frame stud can puncture fuel tank**
  2020–2022 · NHTSA 23V-191
- [ ] **Instrument cluster short**
  2018–2024 · NHTSA 24V-652

- [ ] **Real Rubicon**
  Dana M210 (44-class) front and M220 rear with Tru-Lok electronic lockers, Rock-Trac with 4:1 low range, and an electronic sway-bar disconnect. Sport and Sahara have the M186 ('Dana 30') front and M200 ('Dana 35') rear, with an optional limited slip, and Command-Trac with 2.72:1 (Selec-Trac optional on Sahara).
- [ ] **4xe**
  Plug-in hybrid with a 2.0 turbo, 17 kWh battery, 375 hp and 470 lb-ft; it has a charge port and a smaller 17.2-gal tank (confirm in manual). Check that the battery-fire recall (25V-741) has been done.
- [ ] **Rubicon 392**
  6.4 Hemi with 470 hp and 470 lb-ft, four-door only, with full-time Selec-Trac and the ZF 8HP75. Sold 2021–2025 as the Rubicon 392 ('Final Edition' in 2024–25), then as the Moab 392 for 2026. Check whether it has the 35-inch Xtreme Recon setup.
- [ ] **EcoDiesel**
  3.0 VM Motori turbodiesel V6 (260 hp), four-door only, 2020–2023. Check the high-pressure fuel pump recalls (22V-767 and 23V-263) have been completed.
- [ ] **Xtreme Recon**
  Factory LT315/70R17 BFGoodrich KO2s on 17×8 beadlock-capable wheels, 4.56 gears and a 1.5 in lift, offered from 2021 on the four-door Rubicon and 392.
- [ ] **Selec-Trac**
  The full-time MP3022 Selec-Trac transfer case (2.72:1 low) is a Sahara option and standard on the Rubicon 392; other Rubicons use Rock-Trac (4:1).

NOTES

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